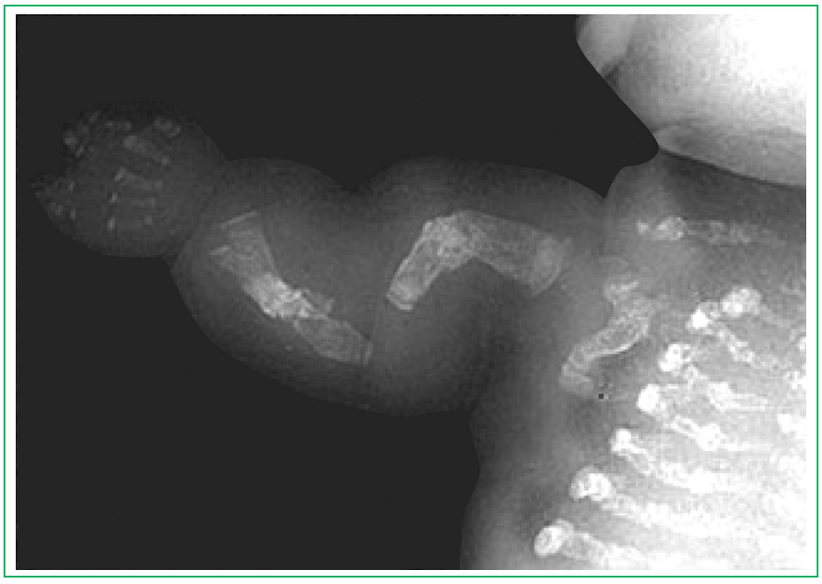


Figure 3.18 X-ray image of lethal O.I of a fetus showing fractures

The process by which a polypeptide chain acquires its 3-dimensional structure is known as protein folding. It is a complex process and the exact mechanism by which a protein folds to its three dimensional structure has not been understood so far. Quite often many proteins misfold. Some proteins when misfolded form fibrillar structure of β pleated sheets. This misfolding can be spontaneous or could be because of mutations. These misfolded proteins aggregate in neurons and can lead to amyloid disease such as Alzheimer's disease, which is a **neuro degenerative disease.**

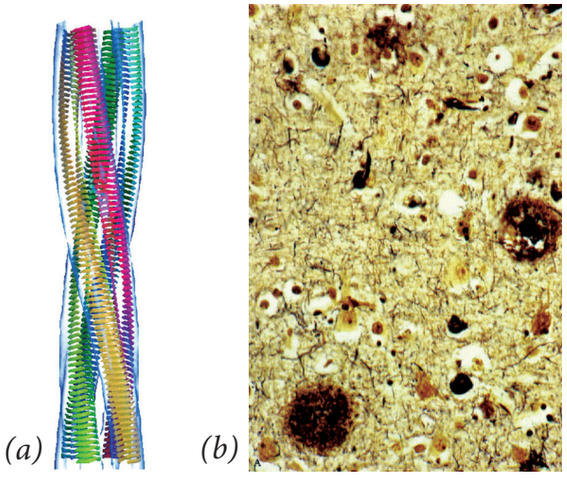


Figure 3.19 (a) Model of an amyloid fibril and (b) Amyloid plaques in temporal cortex

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